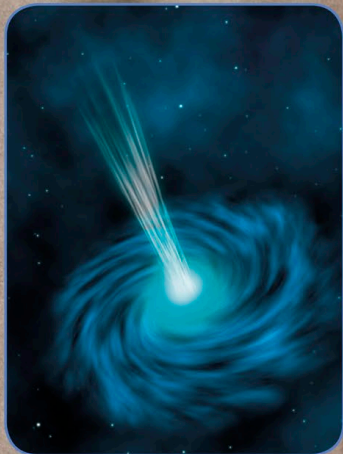


MAARTEN SCHMIDT

Born 1929



Artist's impression of a quasar

"Quasar" is
short for
"quasi-stellar
radio source".

Astronomers had identified mysterious, star-like objects that emitted radio waves. In 1963, Maarten Schmidt found that one of these, 3C 273, lies billions of light years away. For it to be visible, it must be extremely bright. Astronomers called objects like this "quasars", short for "quasi-stellar radio source".

DATA FILE



KEY DISCOVERY: Discovered quasars



COUNTRY OF ORIGIN: The Netherlands



YEAR OF ACHIEVEMENT: 1963